

Apart from these features Facebook allows you to embed functionalities called applications in your profile. Applications are nifty gadgets which do small things like listing the books you have read to modifying the fields of your profile to include newer options. Most of these are designed by individuals and third party developers.

If you have information on Facebook that you want to share in other Web sites use the Facebook badge, and even design a new one if you are not satisfied with the default. Mini-Feeds on your profile is like an activity log; it keeps track of everything that you have done during your stay at the site. Pokes are a way on Facebook to break the ice or to be used as reminders, though they have many other connotations for different users. Facebook users can download a custom toolbar for Firefox 2.0 or add a Facebook search engine to FF / IE7.0's search box. Marketplace is a newly added feature where you can conduct business. Joining Facebook entitles you to a free gift which is a thumbnail, but subsequent gifts have to be paid for.

Joining and registering were no brainers, but what really ate up our time was the amount of searching we had to do to get to some areas. The help sections were exhaustive and once you spend some time on the site you will get the hang of it. For non members it is definitely worth a visit, if only for a change of scene from your normal networking haunts.

2.4 www.spaces.live.com

Earlier known as MSN Spaces, Windows Live Spaces is Microsoft's foray into social networking. And when Microsoft does something, they are almost like communists. They do things big. So is it with Live Spaces. With a user base of over

